

Understanding the text of holy Qur'an

Makkee&Madanee Revelations:

The Definition of *Makkee* and *Madanee*: There are three methodologies by which the makee and madanee revelations are defined.

The first definition relies upon the time of revelation, taking prophet (SAW) hijrah (emigration) as the division factor. According to this definition, if a verse was revealed before the hijrah , it is considered Makee, and if revealed after hijrah ,it is considered Madanee.

The second definition relies upon the place where the verse was revealed. If a verse was revealed in Madinah , it is madanee, and it was revealed in Makkah ,it is makee.

The third definition depends upon the addressees of the verse. If the verse is meant for the Quraysh and the polytheists of Makkah ,it is considered makee, and if the verse is addressing the Muslims or hypocrites of Madinah, it will be considered madanee.

THE CHARACTERISTICS OF *MAKKEE* AND *MADANEE* REVELATIONS:

Characteristics of Makkee revelations are:

(1)The call to the pure worship of Allah (*tawheed*) ,by affirming His names and attributes, and rejecting all false deities and idols .

(2) The establishment of the ‘ *aqeedah* (beliefs), by affirming belief in prophet hood ,the angels, the previously revealed scriptures, and the Day of Judgment .The *makkee soorahs* ,therefore, elaborated upon the stories of the previous prophet ,the description of the Day of Resurrection , the description of Heaven and Hell and the rewards and punishments in them , and other aspects of ‘ *aqeedah* .

(3) The establishment of morality. For example , *makkee* verses called for good conduct, respecting orphan's properties, and treating female infants properly (as there was a custom amongst the Arabs of female infanticide). At this stage , only a broad basis of morality was established ; specific laws (concerning fornication , drinking, etc...) were not revealed.

4) The stories of the previous generations. The *makkee soorahs* emphasized the stories of the previous prophets, and the trials and tribulations that the believers faced at the hand

of the disbelievers. These soorahs repeatedly warned the idolaters of the punishment that the earlier nation had received.

5) Every soorah that has the oath, "Nay(kalaa)!" is makkee. This oath only occurs in the last half of the Qur'aan, in over fifteen soorahs.

6) All soorahs that begin with disjointed letters (al-muqatta'at), such as Alif-Lam-Meem, and Ha-Meem, are makkee, with the exceptions of al-baqarah and Aali-Imraan.

7) All soorahs which have a verse of prostration (sajdah lit-tilaawah) are makkee.

8) All soorahs which mention the stories of the previous prophets, and the story of Aadam and the creation, are makkee, with the exception of Soorah al-Baqarah.

9) Generally, the verses in makkee revelations are short and succinct, using strong words and frequent oaths.

Characteristics of madanee revelations are:

1) In the madanee verses, the detailed laws of prayer, charity, fasting and pilgrimage were revealed

2) The establishment of a system of laws governing individual, familial and societal relationships. Included in this are laws for Jihaad, marriage, inheritance, the laws concerning the relationship of the Islamic state in war and peace, the relationship of the Muslims with other religious groups, and the punishments for specific crimes (hudood)

3) The discussion with the Jews and Christians concerning their religions, and an exposition of their faults and shortcomings is another feature of Madanee revelations. The madanee verses also discussed in detail the history of the children of Israeel, and how Allah dealt with their faithlessness and treachery.

4) The madanee verses mentions the hypocrites and their plots except Soorah Al-Ankaboot, in order to warn the Muslims against their evils, caution the Muslims not to become like them.

5) Generally, madanee verses are longer than their makkee counterparts.

THE BENEFITS OF KNOWING MAKEE AND MADANEE VERSES

Some of the benefits of the knowledge of makkee and madanee verses are:

1) This knowledge is essential in arriving at a proper understanding and interpretation of the Qur'aan, as it is a key to understanding the reason behind the revelation of a verse or soorah. The fact that the verse,

“Verily, He Who has given you(O Muhammad) the Qur’aan will return you back to the place of return.(i.e., Makkah)”[28:85]

Was revealed during the hijrah, for example, helps in understanding that Allah is consoling the Prophet (SAAS) that he will eventually return to Makkah.

2) This knowledge helps differentiate the abrogated verses from the non-abrogated ones .For example, if two verses deal with the same topic and give different rulings ,but one is madanee and the other is make ,the rulings is taken from the madanee verse.

3) It gives an insight into the life of the Prophet (SAAS).

4) It gives the history of the gradual revelation of the sharee’ah.

5) It lays out the procedure and methodology of calling to Islam.

Asbabunnuzal(The causes of Revelation)

Definition of *Asbabunnuzal*:

Literal meaning: Asbabunnuzul is a compound word which is formed from two separate words sabab and nuzul. The Arabic word sabab is plural in form which means causes, reasons and the word nuzul means descending, revelation. So, asbabunnuzul means the causes of revelation.

Technical meaning : TheAsbabunuzal is defined to be a specific incident, occurrence question that was a direct cause of revelation of a particular verse. In addition, it must have occurred shortly before the revelation. In other words the verse must have been revealed in response to the occurrence and give an answer or ruling pertaining to that occurrence.

Example:يُوصِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي أَوْلَادِكُمْ:

“Allah commands you with regards to your children”(4:11)

These verse was revealed when the prophet visited JaabiribnAbdillaah while he was sick,and he asked the Prophet how he should divide his money among his children. Therefore the sabab an-nuzool of this verse was the question that jaabir asked the prophet.

Therefore, all the verse of the Quran may be divided into two categories with respect asbaab an-nuzool, as follow:

1)The verse revealed without a sabab an-nuzool.Most of the verse of the Qur'an were revealed without a particular incident occurring before their revelation .The primary purpose for the revelation of the Qur'an was to

“guide mankind out of the darkness into the light”

But this does not qualify as a sabab an-nuzool for the revelation of the Qur'an.

As for the statement of IbnMas'ood

“.....and there is not a single verse in the Quran except that I know the reason behind its revelation.....,”this does not imply that every verse had a specific cause of revelation, but rather that when such a cause existed,Ibn Mas'ood was aware of it.

2) Those verse revealed in response to a question, or because of an incident or occurrence.

The classification of Asbabunnuzul:The Asbabunnuzulare divided into the following types.

- Asbabunnuzul of clear wordings
- Asbabunnuzul of vague wordings
- Multiple Asbabunnuzul for one verse
- Multiple verses for one Asbabunnuzul
- A person as Asbabunnuzul
- An incident as Asbabunnuzul
- A question as Asbabunnuzul

Asbabunnuzul of clear wordings:It is a statement of theCompanionconcerning the sabab an-nuzool of a verse in which the wording is clear and unequivocal . For example, the statement: ‘The reason this verse was revealed was.....,or’The Prophet was asked concerning such –and-such, and so Allah revealed.....’.If the sabab an-nuzool is narrated in such a manner, then there is no doubt or ambiguity in accepting it.

Example: Narrated Ibn 'Abbas: the verse '**Obey Allah and obey the apostle and those of you (Muslims) whoare in authority ...'** (4: 59) was revealed in connection with 'Abdullah bin Hudafa bin Qais bin 'Adi whenthe Prophet appointed him as the commander of a sariyya (army detachment). [Bukhari, VI, No. 108.]

Asbabunnuzul of vague wordings: In this type, the phrasing of the statement is not explicit but equivocal in nature; For example the statement, ‘This verse was revealed

concerning such-and such an act. Scholars have differed with regards to the acceptance of this type of report as sabab an-nuzool. This is because this type of statement does not necessarily imply that the ruling of the verse applies to that case, or it could also imply that the act was the asbabun nuzul. In other words, due to ambiguity in the statement, it does not give certain knowledge, and can be interpreted either way.

Example: Narrated 'Urwa: Az-Zubair quarreled with a man from the Ansar because of a natural mountainous stream at Al-Harra. The Prophet said: O Zubair, irrigate (your land) and then let the water flow to your neighbor. The Ansar said: O Allah's apostle (this is because) he is your cousin? At that the Prophet's face became red (with anger) and he said: O Zubair. Irrigate (your land) and then withhold the water till it fill the land up to the walls and then let it flow to your neighbor. So the Prophet enabled Az-Zubair to take his full right after the Ansari provoked his anger. The Prophet had previously given an order that was in favor of both of them. Az-Zubair said: 'I don't think but this verse was revealed in this connection: But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them' (4: 65). [Bukhari, VI, No. 109.]

Multiple Asbabunnuzul for one verse: It is possible that a verse may have several asbabunnuzul. For example, the verse مَا كَانَ لِلنَّبِيِّ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَنْ يَسْتَغْفِرُوا لِلْمُشْرِكِينَ

It is not proper for the Prophet and those who believe to ask forgiveness for the polytheists and pagans.....>>(9:113)

There are three reports concerning the revelation of this verse, all of which are equally authentic. In addition, it is not possible for all of these incidents to have occurred simultaneously. The first report is that of at-Timidhee, who reports from 'Alee ibn Abee Taalib that a person asked forgiveness for his parents, even though they died as pagans. When the prophet was informed of this, then the verses were revealed. The second report is from al-Hakim who narrates from Ibn Mas'ood that once the Prophet sat next to a grave, and started crying. Then he said, "This grave is the grave of my mother. I asked Allah's permission to pray for her, but he forbade me." He then read the above verse. And lastly, al-Bukhaaree narrates that when AbooTaalib was on his death bed, the prophet tried to convince him to become a Muslim. However, Aboojahl taunted him saying "O AbooTaalib, are you going to turn away from the religion of (your father)'Abdul Muttalib?" Therefore AbooTaalib died upon the religion of his father. The Prophet said "I will continue to seek forgiveness for you as long as I am not prohibited from doing from so "At this, Allaah revealed the verse.

Faced with these three authentic narrations, it is concluded that it was revealed three separate times, on each of these occasions

It should be mentioned that some scholars deny that any verse of the Quran was revealed more than once. They claim that once a verse was revealed, there was no need to reveal

the verse again. Therefore, when it comes to reports on asbaab an-nuzool such as these, they will try to find which of these reports is the strongest (so, for example, with regards to the above story they will prefer the narration in al-Bukhaaree, since this is the most authentic book of hadeeth. However, most scholars do hold the view that it is also possible that certain verses were revealed on more than one occasion, saying that this is an indication of importance of such verses.

Multiple verses for one Asbabunnuzul: It is also possible that a number of verses were revealed in response to one occasion or question, thus making one sabab an-nuzul for a number of different verses. For example, Umme Salamah, one of the wives of the prophet, asked, “O Messenger of Allah! I see that Allah always mentions men (in the Qur’aan), but not women!” In response to her comment, Allah revealed three verses: firstly the verse,

وَلَا تَتَمَنَّوْا مَا فَضَّلَ اللَّهُ بِهِ بَعْضُكُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ لِلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا كَسَبُوا وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا كَسَبْنَ

“Do not wish for that which Allah has made some of you to excel over others. For men there is a reward for what they have earned, and for women there is a reward for what they have earned. . .” (4:32)

Secondly, the verse,

إِنَّ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَالْمُسْلِمَاتِ وَالْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ وَالْقَانِتِينَ وَالْقَانِتَاتِ وَالصَّادِقِينَ وَالصَّادِقَاتِ وَالصَّابِرِينَ وَالصَّابِرَاتِ وَالْخَاشِعِينَ وَالْخَاشِعَاتِ وَالْمُتَصَدِّقِينَ وَالْمُتَصَدِّقَاتِ وَالصَّانِمِينَ وَالصَّانِمَاتِ وَالْحَافِظِينَ فُرُوجَهُمْ وَالْحَافِظَاتِ وَالذَّاكِرِينَ اللَّهَ كَثِيرًا وَالذَّاكِرَاتِ أَعَدَّ اللَّهُ لَهُمْ مَغْفِرَةً وَأَجْرًا عَظِيمًا

“Verily the believing men and women, and the Muslim men and women, and the obedient men and women Allah has prepared for them forgiveness and a great reward” [33:35]

And lastly, the verse,

فَاسْتَجَابَ لَهُمْ رَبُّهُمْ أَنِّي لَا أُضِيعُ عَمَلَ عَامِلٍ مِنْكُمْ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ أَوْ أُنْثَى بَعْضُكُمْ مِنْ بَعْضٍ

“Never will I allow to be lost the work of any of you, be he male or female. You are (members), one of another” [3:195]

There are a number of different narrations in which Umm Salamah asked the Messenger of Allah this question, and each narration gives one of these verses. Therefore, it is concluded that all of these verses were revealed because of this one sabab an nuzzol.

A person as Asbabunnuzul:A person may be as asbabun nuzul of a verse. This person is either a companion or Prophet (SAW).

- Companion:

The Companions used to record which verses were revealed concerning them, as this was a source of honor and distinction for them. For example, Sa'ad Ibn Abee Waqqaas stated, "Four verses of the Qur'aan were revealed concerning me (or because of me).

(The first one was due to the fact that) my mother promised not to eat or drink until I leave the Prophet Muhammad. Therefore, Allah revealed,

وَإِنْ جَاهِدَاكَ عَلَىٰ أَنْ تُشْرِكَ بِي مَا لَيْسَ لَكَ بِهِ عِلْمٌ فَلَا تُطِعْهُمَا وَصَاحِبُهُمَا فِي الدُّنْيَا مَعْرُوفًا

"But if they (your parents) try to force you to join in worship with me partners of which you have no knowledge, then do not obey them, but treat them in this world with kindness [31:15]

The second verse was revealed concerning the booty we had captured in war. There was a sword that I really liked, so I asked the Messenger of Allah to give it to me. Allah revealed,

يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الْأَنْفَالِ "They ask you concerning the spoils of war [8:1]

The third verse was revealed when Prophet visited me when I was sick. I asked him, 'O Prophet! I wish to distribute my wealth, should I give away half of it? He answered, 'No'. I then asked, 'A third?' He did not respond to this, so from then onwards (a bequest) of a third was allowed. The verse is

كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمْ إِذَا حَضَرَ أَحَدُكُمُ الْمَوْتُ إِنْ تَرَكَ خَيْرًا الْوَصِيَّةُ لِلْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ حَقًّا عَلَى الْمُتَّقِينَ

"Prescribed for you when death approaches [any] one of you if he leaves wealth [is that he should make] a bequest for the parents and near relatives according to what is acceptable - a duty upon the righteous". (2:180)

And the fourth one occurred when I was drinking wine with a group of the Answer. One of them hit me on my nose (because he was drunk), so I went to the Prophet (to complain), and then Allah revealed the verse prohibiting wine."

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْخَمْرُ وَالْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ رَجْسٌ مِنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ فَاجْتَنِبُوهُ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ

O you who have believed, indeed, intoxicants, gambling, [sacrificing on] stone alters [to other than Allah], and divining arrows are but defilement from the work of Satan, so avoid it that you may be successful. (5:90)

- Prophet (SAW) himself:

In fact, sometime the Prophet Muhammad was himself the Sabab an-Muzool of a verse. For example, Al-Bukhaaree reports that once the Prophet asked Jibreel, “Why do you not visit us more often?” Allah then revealed,

وَمَا نُنَزِّلُ إِلَّا بِأَمْرِ رَبِّكَ

“And we (the angels) do not descend except by the command of your Lord” [19:64]

In this case, the Prophet’s question was the Sabab an-Nuzool of the verse.

An incident as Asbabunnuzul: An incident also may be a sababun nuzul. For example,

Narrated Ibn ‘Abbas: the Prophet went out towards Al-Batha’ and ascended the mountain and shouted: ‘O Sabahah’, so, the Quraish people gathered around him. He said: Do you see? If I tell you that an enemy is going to attack you in the morning or in the evening, will you believe me?’ They replied: ‘Yes’. He said – ‘Then I am plain Warner to you of a coming severe punishment’. Then the surah concerning Abu Lahab was revealed in response to this event, when Abu Lahab said: May you perish!’

A question as Asbabunnuzul: It is also possible that a question is the asbabun nuzul of a specific verse. For example,

“يُوصِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي أَوْلَادِكُمْ” (4:11) Allah commands you with regards to your children

These verses was revealed when the prophet visited Jaabir ibn Abdillaah while he was sick, and he asked the Prophet how he should divide his money among his children. Therefore the sabab an-nuzool of this verse was the question that jaabir asked the prophet.

The Benefits of Knowing Asbaab an-Nuzul :

Some of the benefits of this knowledge are as follows:

- To arrive at a proper understanding of the verse, and remove any misinterpretation or doubts concerning the verse’s meaning.
- To understand the circumstances in which a verse was revealed.
- To apply the verses in a proper manner.

- To know the person who caused the revelation of the verse.

***Al-Naskh* (Abrogation) :**

- **Definition of Naskh:**

Literal meaning: The Arabic word *Al – Naskh* is a verbal noun. It is used for the following meanings:

To remove, to abolish, to abrogate’.

‘To transcribe, to copy’..

‘To replace, to supersede’

Terminological meaning: In the terminology of Science of the Qur’an, it refers to the abrogation of a ruling by a ruling that was revealed after it.

Therefore, at least two ruling must be involved, the *naasikh* and the *mansookh*. The *naasikh* ruling is the ruling that repeals the *mansookh*; *naasikh*, the participle, is the ruling that does the abrogating, while *mansookh*, the passive form, is the ruling that is abrogated.

The Proof of Naskh:

The vast majority of scholars have upheld the validity of naskh. Only some *Shee’ee* and *Mu’ tazilee* scholars (such as Aboo Muslim al-Isfahaanee, d,322 A.H.), have raised objections concerning *naskh*. Aboo Muslim claims that, while it is not inconceivable that *naskh* can occur, there are no ruling to demonstrate it. However, as Ibn al-Jawzee (d. 597 A.H.) mentioned, Aboo Muslim was the first scholar to deny the validity of *naskh*, and in this he went against the consensus (*ijmaa’*) of all the scholars before him.

Aboo Muslim’s view has been aptly refuted, since the Qur’aan and *Sunnah* is very explicit on the occurrence of *naskh*. The Qur’aan says,

“We do not abrogate a ruling, or cause it to be forgotten, except that We substitute in its place something better than it, or similar to it. Are you unaware that Allah is indeed capable of all things.” 2:106

In another verse, Allah says,

وَإِذَا بَدَّلْنَا آيَةً مَكَانَ آيَةٍ وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا يُنَزَّلُ قَالُوا إِنَّمَا أَنْتَ مُفْتَرٍ بَلْ أَكْثَرُهُمْ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ

“And when We change a verse (in the Qur’aan) in place of another – and Allah knows best what He sends down – they say, ‘You (O Muhammad) are but a forger.’ Nay, (but) most of them are ignorant.” 16:101

In these verses, the concept of *naskh* is very explicit,

Apart from these verses, there are numerous instances in the Qur’aan or *Sunnah* where *naskh* has been mentioned explicitly. For example, initially, a Muslim in battle was prohibited from fleeing from the enemy if he were faced with ten enemy soldiers (a ratio of 1 to 10, cf. 8:65). However, Allah then revealed,

“Now, Allah *has lightened your (burden)*, for He knows that there is a weakness in you. So if there are one hundred of you, they shall overcome two hundred...” 8:66

الْآن خَفَّفَ اللَّهُ عَنْكُمْ وَعَلِمَ أَنَّ فِيكُمْ ضَعْفًا فَإِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ مِائَةٌ صَابِرَةٌ يَغْلِبُوا مِائَتَيْنِ وَإِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ أَلْفٌ يَغْلِبُوا أَلْفَيْنِ بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ

The ratio was then reduced to one Muslim for every two non-Muslim soldiers. In verse, the occurrence of *naskh* is explicit.

With regards to *naskh* in the *Sunnah*, the classic *hadeeth* that is quoted is the Prophet’s statement, “I used to forbid you to visit graves, but now you may freely do so, for they remind you of death.” Once again, the occurrence of *naskh* is explicit.

نَهَيْتُكُمْ عَنْ زِيَارَةِ الْقُبُورِ فَزُورُوهَا فَإِنَّهَا تُرْهِدُ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَتُذَكِّرُ الْآخِرَةَ

The classification of *Naskh*:

The various legal rulings that have been affected by *naskh* may be classified in different categories. They may be classified with respect to the sources of the *naasikh* and *mansookh* rulings, or with respect to their existence or non-existence in the Qur’aan, or with respect to the rulings of the *mansookh* in comparison with the *naasikh*.

A. Classification of *naskh* with regards to the sources of the *naasikh* and *mansookh*:

There are four logical scenarios of *naskh* with regards to the sources of the *naasikh* and *mansookh*:

- **The Qur’aan abrogating the Qur’aan.**

This category is agreed upon by all those who consider the validity of *naskh*. An example of this is the waiting period of a widowed lady; initially she was to be maintained from the wealth of her deceased husband for a period of one year:

وَالَّذِينَ يَتُوفُونَ مِنْكُمْ وَيُذَرُونَ أَزْوَاجًا وَصِيَّةً لِأَزْوَاجِهِمْ مَتَاعًا إِلَى الْحَوْلِ غَيْرَ إِخْرَاجٍ فَإِنْ خَرَجْنَ فَلَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْكُمْ فِي مَا فَعَلْنَ فِي أَنْفُسِهِنَّ مِنْ مَعْرُوفٍ وَاللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ حَكِيمٌ

“And those of you who die and leave behind their wives should bequeath for them a year’s maintenance and residence, without turning them out...” 2:240

Later on, this ruling was abrogated by the verse,

وَالَّذِينَ يَتُوفُونَ مِنْكُمْ وَيُذَرُونَ أَزْوَاجًا يَتَرَبَّصْنَ بِأَنْفُسِهِنَّ أَرْبَعَةَ أَشْهُرٍ وَعَشْرًا

“And those of you who die and leave behind their wives, their (wives) should wait four months and ten days...” 2:234

2.The Qur’aan abrogating the *Sunnah*.

The majority of scholars have agreed to the validity of this type of naskh. An example of this is the changing of the qiblah; the muslims used to pray towards Jerusalem by the command of the Prophet(SM) (i.e. the sunnah), but eventually the Qur’aan revealed that the direction of the qiblah was to be Makkah

قَدْ نَرَى تَقَلُّبَ وَجْهِكَ فِي السَّمَاءِ فَلَنُوَلِّيَنَّكَ قِبْلَةً تَرْضَاهَا فَوَلِّ وَجْهَكَ شَطْرَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ وَحَيْثُ مَا كُنْتُمْ فَوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ شَطْرَهُ

“Verily! We have seen the turning of your face (O Muhammad) towards the heavens.Surely ,we shall turn you to a qiblah that shall please you! So turn your face in the direction of the Masjid ul-Haraam (at Makkah)”...[2:144]

The initial qiblah was based on the sunnah ,and the abrogation came down in the Qur’aan. This incident is clear proof that Qur’aan can abrogate the sunnah.

3) The *Sunnah* abrogating the Qur’aan.

The category maybe further subdivided into two categories :

i) A mutawaatir hadeeth abrogating the Quran. This was allowed by Imaam Malik(d.179AH) and Aboo Hanifa (d.150 A.H),and one of the opinions of Imaam Ahmad (d.241 A.H) . They reasoned that both are forms of revelation from Allaah, and since both give indisputable knowledge (qat’ee ath-thuboot), they may abrogate one another.

An Example of a muttawaatir hadeeth abrogating the Qur’aan is the verse concerning leaving bequest to heirs:

كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمْ إِذَا حَضَرَ أَحَدُكُمْ الْمَوْتُ إِنْ تَرَكَ خَيْرًا الْوَصِيَّةُ لِلْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ حَقًّا عَلَى الْمُتَّقِينَ

“It is prescribed for you ,when any one of you approaches death and he has wealth, that he make a bequest to his parents and next of kin....”[2:180]

This ruling was abrogated by the hadeeth of the prophet (SM) in which he said ,”There is no bequest to an heir.”

ii) An ahead hadeeth abrogating the Qur’aan. Most of the scholars did not allow this type of naskh, since they reasoned , the Qur’aan is murrawatir , and provides indisputable knowledge of authenticity (qat’ee ath-thuboot).

The view, although representing the majority opinion ,is not necessarily the correct one. Ash-shanqeetee discusses this question in detail, and concludes that an ahead hadeeth can abrogate the Qur’aan, although such an occurrence is rare. He does give the condition however that it must be known for certain that the ahad narration occurred after the revelation of the verse. An example of this, according to ash-shanqeetee, is the prohibition of the flash of domesticated donkeys, for it is known that this occurred during the battle of Khaybar, and as such abrogated the previous ruling that it was allowed (by the understanding of 16:45)

Imaam ash- Shaafiee(d.204 A.H) did not allow the Qur’aan to abrogate the sunnah, nor the sunnah to abrogate the Qur’aan .He felt the Qur’aan could only abrogate the Quran ,and the same with the sunnah.

4) The Sunnah abrogating the Sunnah.

This was also allowed by all those who upheld the validity of naskh. This category may be further subdivided into four categories:

- A mutawaatir hadeeth abrogating another mutawaatir hadeeth.
- An ahaad hadeeth abrogating another ahaad hadeeth.
- An mutawaatir hadeeth abrogating ahaad hadeeth.
- An ahaad hadeeth abrogating a mutawaatir hadeeth .

The first three categories agreed upon by all scholars. The last category , that of an ahaad hadeeth abrogating a mutawaatir one, is held by those who allow an ahaad hadeeth to abrogate the Qur’aan (such as ash-Shanqeetee). The majority however , do not allow the occurrence of the fourth category.

B. Classification of *naskh* with respect to verses and rulings in the Qur’aan

With respect to verses in the Qur'aan , it is possible that either the recitation of the verse, or the ruling ,or both have been abrogated. As was alluded to in earlier chapters , there existed verses that used to be recited as part of the Qur'aan, but whose recitation was later abrogated at the command of Allah. Some of these abrogated verses dealt with legal rulings.

Thus (with respect to the Qur'aan only and not the sunnah) naskh may be classified as follows:

- The abrogation of the ruling and the verse (Naskh al-Hukm wa at-Tilaawah).

In other words , neither is the verse present in the mus-haf, nor is its ruling applied.

An example of this type is the report of 'Aa'ishah, in which she said ,”It had been revealed in the Qur'aan that ten clear sucklings (of a baby with a woman) made marriage unlawful (i.e. that the baby would be considered her foster-child). This was later abrogated (and substituted) by five sucklings , and the prophet(SM) died and it was before that time (found) in the Qur'aan .”In this case ,neither is the relevant verse found in the mus-haf, nor is the ruling applicable.

2) the abrogation of the ruling without the verse (Naskh al-Hukm doona at-Tilaawah).

When this occurs, the relevant verse is still recited and is present in the mus-haf, but the ruling does not apply. An example of this is the verse prescribing the waiting period of one year for the widow(2:240). Even though this ruling does not apply anymore, the verse is still recited as part of the Qur'aan .

Another example is the verse that initially prescribed the punishment for fornication.

“ and those of your woman who commit illegal sexual intercourse, take the evidence of four witnesses amongst you against them. If they testify, then confine them to their houses until death overtake them, or until Allaah ordains for them some (other) way”.[4:15]

This verse was abrogated by the verse in soorah an-Noor,

“The(unmarried) woman and man guilty of illegal sexual intercourse flog each of them with a hundred stripes...”[24:2]

3) The abrogation of the verse without the ruling(Naskh at-tilaawah doona al-hukm).

In this case ,Allaah remove the verse from the Qur'aan but left the relevant ruling. For example, a verse in the Qur'aan used to order those who had committed,

“Adultery to be stoned to death,

Stoning is a duty laid down in

Allaah's book for married men and women who commit adultery when proof is established.” In fact even the wording of the verse of stoning has been preserved in other authentic narrations, “wa ash-shaykhu wa-shaykhatu idha zanayaa farjumoo hum al-batha nakaala min allaah...”meaning , “ And the married men or women, if they commit adultery,

Then stone them as a retribution of form Allaah.”

C. Classification of *naaskh* with respect to the degree of difficulty of rulings

The naasikh ruling might be a concession form the mansookh , or it might be one that requires more effort. With respect to the degree of difficulty of rulings, the rulings of naasikh and mansookh may be divided into four categories:

- The naasikh ruling is more difficult or more constrained then mansookh. An example of this are the rulings pertaining to adultery. Initially , the punishment for both married and unmarried illegal sexual intercourse was lifelong imprisonment (cf.4:15). Allaah then revealed the verse of flogging for the unmarried and stoning for the married persons(cf.24:2).

2) The naasikh ruling is equivalent to the mansookh ruling in difficulty.

For example, the verses that were revealed concerning the change of the qiblah from Jerusalem to Makkah; in this case, the naasikh ruling is equivalent to the mansookh in effort.

3) The naasikh ruling is a concession from mansookh.

In this case, the naasikh ruling was earlier for the Muslims than the mansookh.

An example that has already been quoted is with regards to the waiting period of windows; it was reduced from one year to four months and ten days. Another example that was mentioned is with regards to the prohibition of fleeing from the battlefield when the ratio of muslims was 1 to 10; this was later abrogated and the ratio reduced to one Muslim for every two non-Muslims.

4) There is no naasikh command in place of the mansookh.

In other words, Allah repealed the law in to. An example of this is the command to give charity before going to see the Prophet () Privately. Allah revealed,

“O you who believed! When you want to consult the Messenger in private

Spend something in charity before your private consultations”[58:12]

Allah then replied this law totally,

“ Are you afraid of spending in charity before your consultations. If you do not do it ,and Allah has forgiven you (for not doing it), then (at last)

Offer prayer perfectly...”

Therefore Allah forgive this charity from them, and they were not required to do it.

The Benefits of Knowing Naasikh and Mansookh

- 1) To understand and implement the Quran properly.
- 2) The knowledge of the gradual revelation of the sharee'ah.
- 3) The difference of the Quran and sunnah.

Chapter: 5

Transmission of Quranic revelation

Preservation/Collection & Compilation of the Holy Quran:

There are three distinct stages of the compilation of the Qur'aan. The first is the preservation of the Qur'aan during the lifetime of the Prophet. The second, the compilation of the Qur'aan by Aboo Bakr. And the third, the compilation of Uthman.

Preservation/Collection of Qur'aan during Prophet's life: The following phenomena were visible during His time in case of preservation of Qur'aan:

1. Memorization by Prophet Himself:

The Prophet was also very concerned about the preservation of the Qur'aan. He used to be fearful of forgetting the verses that Jibreel recited to him, so he used to start repeating the verses even before Jibreel finished. Allah then revealed, to reassure him,

“Move not your tongue with haste, to recite it. It is for us to collect it and give you the ability to recite it” [75:16-17]

Also the Prophet used to spend large portions of the night reciting the Qur'aan.

In later years, when larger portions of the Qur'aan had been revealed, the Prophet used to recite, in one rak'ah, Soorah al-Baqarah, Aali Imraan, and an-Nisaa (around a sixth of the Qur'aan).

2. Memorization by Companions: The companions shared the prophet's concern for the preservation of the Qur'aan. They would recite and memorize Qur'aan as much as possible. Those who were famous for having memorized most if not all of the Qur'aan were Abu Bakr, Umar Ibn al-Khattaab, Uthman Ibn Affan, Alee Ibn Abee Taalib, Hudhayfah Ibn al-Yamaan, Abdullah Ibn Mas'ood and others. During the incident of Bir Ma'oonah²³⁰ alone, which occurred in the fourth year after the hijrah, seventy reciters (memorizers) of the Qur'aan were killed, and a similar number were killed in the battle of

the Yamaamah (12 A.H.). This shows that many of the companions had memorized most, if not all of the Qur'aan.

There are some narrations, however, that seem to imply that only a certain number of people memorized the Qur'aan during the Prophet's lifetime. For example, a narration in al-Bukhaaree mentions Anas ibn Maalik as saying that only four people memorized the Qur'aan before Prophet's death: Ubay ibn Ka'ab, Mu'aadh ibn Jabal, Zayd ibn Thaabit and Aboo Zayd (his name was Qays ibn as-Sakan). Another narration, also in al-Bukhaaree, states that the Prophet said, "Learn the Qur'aan from four people: 'Abdullah ibn Mas'ood, Saalim, Mu'aadh ibn Jabal, and Ubay ibn Ka'ab."

3. Arrangement for teaching Quran new Muslims:

The prophet (saw) was concerned for new Muslims to teach them the Quran. The concern that the Prophet showed in teaching the Qur'aan is shown by the following narration: 'Ubaadah ibn as-Saamit reported. "Whenever a person migrated to Madeenah, the Prophet would assign him to one of us so that we could teach him Qur'aan. Eventually, the masjid became so noisy because of all of this recitation of the Qur'aan that the Prophet ordered us to lower our voices so as not to distort the meaning (by mixing all of these verses)." ²²⁸ Therefore, the Prophet would ensure that each new Muslim had a teacher to teach him the Qur'aan. Such was the concern of the Prophet in teaching the Qur'aan to the new Muslims that he would even send Companions to other cities to ensure that the Muslims in those cities could memorize the Qur'aan. Even before the hijrah, the Prophet sent two Companions, Ibn Umm Maktoom and Mus'ab ibn 'Umayr, to teach the Muslims of Madeenah the Qur'aan. After the *hijrah*, the Prophet sent Mu'aadh ibn Jabal to Makkah to teach the Qur'aan to those who had not been able to perform the *hijrah*. ²²⁹

4. Record of the Qur'aan by writing: During the later periods, the Prophet also made sure that the Qur'aan was written down, and not just memorized. Al-Bukhaaree reports the following story:

When it was revealed: "Not equal are those believers who sit at home and those that strive in the cause of Allaah..." [4:95]

The Prophet said 'Call Zayd ibn Thaabit for me, and tell him to bring the ink-pot and the scapula bone (i.e.. Paper and pen).' When Zayd came, the Prophet told him, 'Write: "Not equal are those believers who sit at home and those...(to the end of the verse)"'.

This incident shows the haste with which the Prophet recorded the Qur'aan to ensure its preservation. Not only did the Prophet ensure that the Qur'aan was written down, but he also checked whether it was written correctly. Zayd narrates, "I used to write the Revelation (the Qur'aan) for the Prophet, and he would dictate it to me. When he finished, he would command me: 'Read it (back to me).' So I used to recite back to him (what I had written)...."

The parchment on which the Qur'aan was written were so common that Zayd ibn Thaabit reported, "During the lifetime of the Prophet, we used to compile the Qur'aan from

scraps of cloth.”²³⁵ In other words, they used to form the various *soorahs* and join the verses scrap by scrap. The writing materials included cloth, stones, date-palm leaves, saddles and shoulder blades of animals. According to the *Tabaqaat* of Ibn Sa’ad, twenty-four different people acted in the capacity of scribes for the Prophet, among them the four caliphs, and Zayd bin Thaabit.

The Companions also had their own personal copies of the Qur’aan. ;The Prophet had commanded the Companions. “Do not write anything from me except the Qur’aan. Whoever writes anything besides the Qur’aan should burn it.” So common, in fact, were these mus-hafs that the Prophet had to issue an order prohibiting the Companions from traveling to enemy territories with copies of the Qur’aan, for fear that these mus-hafs might fall into enemy hands and thus be disrespected.²³⁷

Those Companions who were famous for their mus-hafs were Ubay ibn Ka’ab, ‘Abdullah ibn Mas’ood, ‘Umar ibn al-Khattab, ‘Alee ibn Abee Taalib, and some of the wives of the Prophet, amongst them ‘Aa’ishah and Hafsa. Some sources have listed over fifteen Companions who were recorded to have written down most of the Qur’aan.²³⁸ These were not complete copies of the Qur’aan, nor was the arrangement of the *soorahs* in them the same as the later arrangement. For example, Ibn Mas’ood had one hundred and six *soorahs*, and the order of the *soorahs* was not the order which is present today. Ubay ibn Ka’ab also had less than one hundred and fourteen *soorahs* and, in addition to the *soorahs* that he had, the prayer for *qunoot*²³⁹ and a *hadeeth* are also found.

The earliest record that exist of the Qur’aan having been written down is during the sixth year of the prophethood (seven years before the *hijrah*), when ‘Umar ibn al-Khattab accepted Islaam. The story of ‘Umar’s conversion mention that his sister had a *saheefah* (parchment) that one of the Companions, Khabaab ibn al-Arath, had brought with him to teach her family, Khabaab would secretly come to the house of ‘Umar’s brother-in-law with this parchment, and teach them the Qur’aan. This parchment had the first few verses of *Soorah*, Taa Haa written on it. After ‘Umar read it, he said, “How beautiful and eloquent is this speech!”²²⁷ and realized that the Qur’aan was a revelation from Allaah and accepted Islaam. This story indicates that the Qur’aan was being recorded and taught to others even during the early stage of the Prophet’s mission, when the Muslims were still being persecuted.

5. Recitation of Quran to angel Jibreel:

It was the practice of the Prophet to recite the Qur’aan to the Angel Jibreel every year, during the month of Ramadaan, and Jibreel would also recite it back to him. Faatimah, the daughter of the Prophet, reported that the Prophet confided in her, “Jibreel used to recite the whole Qur’aan to me every Ramadaan, but this year he recited it to me twice. I do not see (any explanation for this) except that my time (of death) is near.”²⁴¹ In another narration, ‘Aa’ishah added, “The Prophet used to meet Jibreel every night of

Ramadaan, and recite to him the Qur'aan."²⁴² Therefore, the Prophet used to recite the Qur'aan to Jibreel, and used to hear Jibreel's recitation also, and the year that he died, he recited the Qur'aan twice to Jibreel, and heard it from Jibreel twice. During this last recitation, Zayed ibn Thaabit was present.

Why did the Prophet not compile the Quran in His time?

The Prophet did not compile the Qur'aan in one book during his lifetime, nor did he command the Companions to do so. He made sure that the Qur'aan was written down in its totality, but he did not order for it to be compiled between two covers. There are a number of reasons for this:

- There was no pressing need during the lifetime of the Prophet to compile the whole Qur'aan in one book, since the Qur'aan was not in any danger of being lost. There were numerous Companions who had memorized all of it, and each Companion had memorized various portions of it.

- During the lifetime of the Prophet, the Qur'aan used to be continually revealed. Therefore it would not have been feasible to compile all of it in one book, since it had not been completely revealed yet. The last verse was revealed only nine days before the death of the Prophet.

- The arrangement of the verses and *soorahs* was not chronological. Verses that were revealed years after hijrah could be placed, by the command of the Prophet, in the midst of makkan verses, and vice versa. Therefore, the Prophet could not have compiled the Qur'aan in the correct order until all its verses had been revealed.

- There were some revelations that used to be a part of the Qur'aan, but Allaah abrogated their recitation.²⁴³ During the lifetime of the Prophet, this abrogation could occur at any time; therefore it was essential that the *wahy* be terminated before the Qur'aan be compiled.

To summaries, when the Prophet passed away, the entire Qur'aan had been memorized by many of the Companions, and existed in written form, but it had not been compiled between two covers. Rather, it was scattered in loose fragments that were owned by different people. Some Companions also had substantial (yet incomplete) copies of the Qur'aan.

Stages of compilation :

First compilation by Aboo Bakr :

1. Issue of Apostasy: After the death of the Prophet, the Companions chose the best of them to be their leader, and Aboo Bakr took over the affairs of the Muslims. The first issue that Aboo Bakr had to deal with was the issue of apostasy. Some 'Muslims' had accepted Islaam during the lifetime of the Prophet for political reasons, and immediately after the death of the Prophet, refused to give allegiance to the new Islaamic state. Many of these 'Muslims' had given their allegiance to people who claimed to be prophets. Aboo Bakr then undertook a series of wars that became known as the 'Wars of Apostasy' against these people, in order to consolidate the Muslim *ummah*.

2. Umar's alarm & solution:

During one of these battles, the Battle of *Yamaamah* (12 A.H.), around seventy Companions who had memorized the Qur'aan were martyred. The death of such a large number of *quraa'* (memorizers of the Qur'aan) alarmed 'Umar, and he went to Aboo Bakr and said, "Many of the memorizers of the Qur'aan have died, and I am scared lest more die in later battles. This might lead to the loss of the Qur'aan, unless you collect it." Umar not only realized the danger of this great loss, but also proposed a solution.

3. Aboo Bakr's hesitation:

Aboo Bakr replied, "How can I do that which the Prophet did not do." Aboo Bakr, the one whom the Prophet trusted the most in all his affairs, could not even think of undertaking a project that the Prophet had not done, nor ordered to be done. He was worried that such a project might be considered an innovation in the religion.

4. Aboo Bakr agreement with Umar:

But "Umar continued to convince him, exhorting him of the merits of such an idea, and proving to him that such a project was in no way an innovation." Umar realized that this act did not qualify as an innovation in the religion, since the compilation of the Qur'aan was not a religious act per se, but rather an act that was of general benefit (*maslaha*) to the Muslims. He continued to convince Aboo Bakr until Aboo Bakr understood 'Umar's arguments and agreed to the project.'

• Selection of Zayd as in charge of compilation:

They both decided to put the Companion Zayd bin Thaabit in charge of collecting the entire Qur'aan in one manuscript. Aboo Bakr told him, "You are an intelligent young man, and we do not doubt you. You used to write the revelation for the Prophet (ﷺ), so we want you to collect the Qur'aan."²⁴⁵

They chose Zayd because he was the person best suited for the job, for the following reasons:

- He was the primary scribe of the Prophet (ﷺ).
- He had memorized the entire Qur'aan during the lifetime of the Prophet (ﷺ).
- He was relatively younger than the other Companions, and thus his memory was sharper.
- He was present at time of the Prophet's (ﷺ) last recitation to Jibreel in the Ramadaan before he (ﷺ) died.
- He was one of the most knowledgeable Companions with regards to the recitation of the Qur'aan.

Thus, it is of little surprise that Aboo Bakr and 'Umar both thought of Zayd as the person who should be given this monumental task, for he had in him all the qualities that were needed for this undertaking. But Zayd too was reluctant, and it was only after both Aboo Bakr and 'Umar convinced him that he agreed to do the task. "It would have been easier for me to move a mountain than do that which they told me to do," he said.

6. Zayd's effort to compile the Quran:

He set about collecting the various fragments of the Qur'aan from 'the pieces of wood and chests of people'. He required at least two people (besides himself) who had learnt the verses from the Prophet (ﷺ) directly, and at least one written copy of the verse written under the supervision of the Prophet (ﷺ), to merit its acceptance into his final compilation. 'Umar ibn al-Khattaab stood up in the mosque and pro-claimed, "Whoever has learnt any Qur'aan from Prophet (ﷺ) then let him bring it forth."²⁵¹

At this, the people brought him the scraps and parchments upon which they had written the Qur'aan. Aboo Bakr told them, "Sit at the door of the mosque, whoever brings you two witness (for a verse), then write it down,"²⁵² Some scholars have interpreted this as meaning two witnesses and two written copies were required.

Zayd reports, "I collected the Qur'aan, until I found the last two verses of *Soorah at-Tawbah* with Khuzaymah ibn Thaabit al-Ansaaree:

There has come to you, from amongst yourselves, a Messenger...[9:128]

I found these verses with him only."²⁵³ This report does not mean that only Khuzaymah had heard the verse from the Prophet (ﷺ), but rather that he was the only one that brought a parchment that had these verses written on it. In fact, when Khazaymah came, 'Uthmaan ibn 'Affaan said, "I testify that these verses have been (revealed from) Allaah!"²⁵⁴

Now, for the first time, the Qur'aan was in one book. Barely two years after the death of the Prophet (ﷺ), when all of the major Companions were still alive, the Qur'aan had been compiled. The written copy of the Qur'aan was called a *mus-haf* (literally meaning a collection of loose papers) and remained with Aboo Bakr and, after his death, with 'Umar, then with Hafsah, the daughter of 'Umar and a wife of the Prophet (ﷺ).

Uthmanic compilation:

Expansion of Muslims territories:

After the death of Aboo Bakr, 'Umar ibn al-Khattaab took over the leadership of the Muslims. Under his auspicious caliphate, the territories of the Muslims expanded

five-fold what they had been. When he passed away, the Muslims controlled the remnants of the Persian Empire, Egypt, Syria and parts of the then-defunct Byzantine (Eastern Roman) Empire.

After 'Umar's death, 'Uthmaan took over the caliphate, and continued the great legacy of his two predecessors. The Muslims were successful in waging jihaad for the cause of Allaah, and spreading the religion of Islaam. One of the places where this was occurring was the territories of Armenia and Azerbaijan. Muslims from different parts of the ummah had joined forces to fight against the enemy.

Difference of opinion among new Muslims:

Unfortunately, the Muslims started differing amongst themselves with regards to the recitation of the Qur'aan. The Muslims from Syria were reciting the Qur'aan differently than the Muslims from Iraq.²⁵⁸ They began contending with each other, each regarding his recitation superior to his brother's. These Muslims were not Companions, and therefore were not trained in the proper manner and etiquette of the recitation of the Qur'aan. One of the Companions who were present amongst them, Hudhayfah ibn al-Yamaan, could not believe what was happening. He advised them to leave this argumentation, but realized that some action must be taken to prevent this occurrence on a larger scale. He therefore left Azerbaijan for Madneenah, to report to the caliph 'Uthmaan.

"O Commander of the Faithful!" Hudhayfah pleaded to 'Uthmaan, "Save this *ummah* before it disagrees about its Book, like the Jews and Christians did before it." Hudhayfah told 'Uthmaan what had occurred amongst the new Muslims in Azerbaijan.

Convention of leading Companions:

'Uthmaan, alarmed by this news, convened a gathering of the leading Companions. He informed them of what Hudhayfah had told him, and requested their advice on this matter. The Companions, in return, asked 'Uthmaan what he thought the best plan of action was. 'Uthmaan told them his opinion: Official copies of the Qur'aan should be written and sent to all the provinces, and all other copies destroyed, so that the ummah would have one standard Qur'aan. Therefore, this standard version would serve to unite the Muslims upon one recitation.

Formation of a committee of four people:

The action of 'Uthmaan was agreed upon by all of the Companions. Therefore, after the Companions agreed to his idea, he requested Hafsa, the daughter of 'Umar ibn al-Khattaab, to loan him the *mus-haf* that Aboo Bakr had ordered to be compiled, which she

did. He then chose a committee of four people, namely Zayd ibn Thaabit, 'Abdullaah ibn az-Zubayr, Sa'eed ibn al-'Aas and 'Abd al-Rahmaan ibn al-Haarith to rewrite the *mus-haf* of Aboo Bakr. He chose Zayd ibn Thaabit for the same reasons that Aboo bakr had done before him, and Sa'eed ibn al-'Aas was known for his knowledge of the Arabic language.

The other two members were respectable Companions, knowledgeable of the Arabic language and of the Qur'aan.

Consultation of committee with other Companies:

Apart from Zayd, the other three committee members were from the Quraysh. This was done on purpose: 'Uthmaan told them, "If you (three) and Zayd differ (on how to spell a word), then spell it in the dialect of the Qurayesh, for verily it was revealed in their dialect."²⁶³ 'Uthmaan said this in response to a difference that arose amongst them concerning the writing of the word '*taboo'*' (in 2:248); should they write the word in the Qurayshee style of '*taboo'*' or the Madanee style of '*taboo'h*' (i.e., with a *taa marbootah*). 'Uthmaan answered them that they should write it as *taboot*, since this was the style of the Quraysh

This incident shows that the committee consulted the other Companions concerning even such minor details as the spellings of certain words. At times, when there was difference of opinion, they even called that particular scribe (if it happened to be other than Zayd) who had written the verse for the Prophet (ﷺ), so that they could ask him how he had spelt the word.

Sending a compiled copy to each province:

After the committee had finished its task, 'Uthmaan ordered that one copy of his *mus-haf* be sent to every province, and ordered the governors of each province to burn all the other copies of the Qur'aan in their provinces. This was a drastic step, but it was necessary if the unity of the Muslims was to be preserved. Every Qur'aan written after this time had to conform letter for letter to 'Uthmaan's *mus-haf*. By his wise decision, 'Uthmaan provided a copy of the Qur'aan that would serve as a model for all future *mus-hafs*. And, as 'Alee pointed out, 'Uthmaan did this with the approval of the Companions.²⁶⁵ In fact 'Alee ibn Abee Taalib said, "If I were in charge (of the affairs of the Muslims) when 'Uthmaan had been, I would have done the same as he did."²⁶⁶

Not only did 'Uthmaan send the actual *mus-hafs* to each province, he also sent Qur'aanic reciters to teach the people the correct recitation of the Qur'aan. He kept Zayd ibn Thaabit in Madeenah; with the Makkan *mus-haf*, he sent 'Abdullaah ibn Saa'ib (d. 63 A.H.); to Syria was sent al-Mugheerah ibn Shu'bah (d. 50 A.H.); Aboo 'Abd ar-Rahmaan as-Sulamee (d. 70 A.H.) was sent to Koofah; and 'Aamir ibn 'Abdul Qays to Basrah (d.

~55 A.h.).²⁶⁷ All of these reciters were well known for their recitation of the Qur‘aan, and it is in fact through them that most of the qira‘aat are preserved.

‘Uthmaan’s compilation occurred in year 24 A.H. or according to others in the early part of 25 A.H.²⁶⁸

Difference between Aboo Bakr & ‘Uthman’s compilation:

- The reason that each of them compiled the Qur‘aan was different. Aboo Bakr compiled the Qur‘aan in response to the large number of deaths of those who had memorized the Qur‘aan, and in fear of its being lost. ‘Uthmaan, on the other hand, compiled the *mus-hafs* in response to the inauthentic recitations that new-comers to Islaam, who were ignorant of the Arabic of the Qur‘aan, were reciting. He wished to unite the Muslims on the proper recitation of the Qur‘aan, and therefore ordered the eradication of all other *mus-hafs*, so that the people would have only one *mus-haf* in their hands.
- The number of people who were in charge of the two compilations was different. Aboo Bakr relied on the person who was the best suited and most qualified to do so, namely Zayd ibn Thabit. ‘Uthmaan, on the other hand, used the services of Zayd but also had three of the major Companions, All of whom were known for their knowledge of the Qur‘aan, to help him.
- The number of *mus-hafs* Aboo Bakr ordered to be made was only one, whereas ‘Uthmaan ordered several.
- Since Aboo Bakr did not face the problem of inauthentic recitations of the Qur‘aan, he did not have to take the step that ‘Uthmaan did in destroying all other written copies of the Qur‘aan. ‘Uthmaan’s decision ensured that all future copies would have to rely upon the original ‘Uthmaanic ones.
- Aboo Bakr compiled the Qur‘aan from ‘...date –palm leaves, wood and the hearts of people....’ Whereas ‘Uthmaan ordered the rewriting of Aboo Bakr’s *mus-haf* in the writing style of the Quraysh.
- Aboo Bakr’s *mus-hafs* according to one opinion, did not concern itself with arranging the *soorahs* properly; only the verses of each *soorah* were arranged. ‘Uthmaan on the other hand, arranged the *soorahs* and verses in their proper arrangement.
- According to some,²⁶⁹ the *mus-haf* of Aboo bakr was written to preserve all seven *ahruf*, but the *mus-haf* of ‘uthmaan only included one *harf* and left out the other six. This opinion, however, does not have any basis to support it.

Chapter – 06

***I'jaz Al-Qur'an* (Inimitability / Miraculous Nature of The Qur'an):**

1. Definition of I'jaaz

The word I'jaaz comes from a-j-z, which means to be incapable of, to be weak. Therefore, the miracle that prophet performed are called mu'jizah, since mankind is incapable of performing such feats.

This word is not used in the Quran or Sunnah, and neither did the companions use it. However, like many other terms in Islamic science it was coined by later scholar and accepted among the Ummah. Probably the first to use this term was Imam Ahamed ibn Hambal(d.204A.H).

Mu'jizah are defined to be acts performed by prophet of a miraculous nature that humans are incapable of imitating. I'jaaz is the concept: Mu'jizah the actual act. An example of a mu'jizah is the transformation of the staff of Moosaa into serpent. The Qu'raanic term for this concept is aayah, or bayyinah.

When applied to Qu'raanic science, the term I'jaaz is used to denote the inimitable quality of the Qu'raan. In other words, the Qur'an is set apart from all other books in that it cannot be rivaled or imitated. This is exclusive to the Quran ;no other books in that it can claim this .No matter how eloquent the poet, how knowledgeable the scholars, how well versed the grammarian none can bring forth anything similar to this science the Qur'an is the speech of Allah and the difference between the speech of Allah and the speech of his creation is difference between Allah and His creation.

2. The Proof for I'jaaz

Part of the Sunnah of Allah is that whenever He sends a prophet, He gives that prophet certain miracles and signs to prove his Prophet hood to his people. The miracles of Moosaa, Eesaa and the other prophet are well-known to all Muslims. Allaah says,

“And we will make him (Eesaa) a Message to children of Israa'eel,(saying),I have come to you with a sign from your Lord that I design for you out of clay as it were the figure of a bird and breathe into it and it becomes a bird by Allah's

leave; and I heal him who was born blind and the leper, I bring the dead into life by the leave of Allah, and I will inform you what you eat and what you store in your house. Surely therein is a sign for you if you believe"[3:49]

So many in fact are the miracles that were given to certain nation, that Allah said,

“And (just),ask the children of Israa’eel how many miracles We gave them....!

Despite all these miracles however ,the major of people rejected their Prophets. The disbelievers of Makah were no exception to the disbelievers of old, and rejected the call of the Prophet. They asked him for miracles

“And they say, ‘We shall not believe in you until in you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us ;Or you have a garden of date palms and grapes and cause rivers to gush forth in their midst abundantly; Or you cause the heavens to fall upon us in pieces as you have pretended or you bring Allah and the angel before us face to face ;Or you have a house of adorable material(i,e, gold and silver),or you ascend up you into the sky, and even then we will put no faith in your ascension until you bring down for us a book that we would read! Answer them (O Muhammad); Glorified be my Lord! I am just a man, sent as a Messenger “[17:90-93]

In another place the result of the showing of these miracles has been told ,

“And even if we had sent down on to them angels and the death had spoke to them ,and We had gathered together all thing before their very eyes even then they would not have believe unless Allah willed but most of them behave ignorantly”[6:111]

Allah then tells the disbelievers the ultimate miracle that the Prophet has been given;

“And they say ,’Why are not miracles sent down to him from his Lord? Say :The signs are only with Allah and I am only a plain Warner ‘Is it not a sufficient (miracles) for them that we have sent down to you the book which is recited to them ?Verily herein is a mercy and a reminder for a people who believes:[29:50-1]

Even this however was not sufficient for the disbelievers was not sufficient for the disbelieves Makings .They claimed that the Prophet was a liar who forged the Quran or a magician or one possessed by jinn. They even claimed that they could imitate the Quran;

“And when Our verses are recited to them, they say, ‘We have heard this! If we wish we can say something similar to it. These are nothing but stories of old.”

In response to this, Allah challenged them to fulfill this claim of theirs.

The challenge!

These verses are called the verses of tahaddi (challenge), and this challenge proves the inimitable and miraculous qualities of Qur'an.

These are five verses that issue the tahaddi. They are, in the order occur in the Qur'an, as follows:

“And if you are in doubt as to what We have sent down to Our servant, then produce a soorah similar to it, if you are truthful, but if you do not do it and of a surety you cannot do it- then fear the fire whose fuel are men and stones prepared for the disbelievers.” [2:23-24]

“Or do they say; He (Muhammad) has forged it say: Bring then a soorah like onto it and call upon whom ever you can, besides,Allah if you are truthful”[10:38]

“Or do they say ;’He (Muhammad)has forged it “say Bring then ten forged sorghum similar to it and call upon whosoever you can beside Allah ,if you are truthful”[11:13]

“say if all mankind and jinn gather together to produce the like of the Qur'an they could not produce it even if they helped one another “[17:88]

“or do they say; ‘He has forgot it Nay (Rather) they do not believe let them produce a reaction similar to it if indeed they are truthful”

These five verses mention different quantities to bring forth one verses mention any reaction be brought forth two verses mention one sooaah and one states that a whole Qur'an must be brought .Sorah al Baqarah is madance and the rest of the verses are make which implice that the verses in al Baqarah was the last of these verses to be reviled.

The Order of the Verses

Was there a gaduality in the challenge In other word did the number of soraah that was challenge increase from one to ten to the wole Quran or decrees There are four opinion on this matter:

- The initial challenge was to produce something similar to the whole Quran .this was then reduce to ten sooraah then to finally one sooraah,this is the most common opinion of Ibn Katheer(d.774A.H)

- The initial challenge is to produce only one soorah(10:38).this was then increase to ten soorah then the whole Quran .finally ,in the last of these curse revealed .Allah reduce the challenge back to one soorah
- The initial challenge was to produce the whole Quran .When they were unable to do this the challenge was to reduce to ten soorah that would limited the Quran in prose and syntax ,but not in correct. lastly the challenge was reduce to one soorah that match the Quran in and content. This is the opinion of azzarkashee in his al Burhan.
- This is not gradually in this challenge .In other words in each verse Akkah is challenge in sane thing to the Quran be it in one soorah,tен soorah or the whole Quran .It is the quality of the Quran that must be limited if the challenge is to be met and the quantity.

Another question that must be answered is whether this challenge is still operative, or was it meant only for the disbeliever during the prophet time The Arabs during the time of the prophet used to pride themselves in their skill of poetry and their eloquence. So Allah issued this challenge to them. However this does not that this challenge was only meant for them. Since the Quran is meant to be miracle until the day of Judgement.THE TRUTH OF THE MATTER is that there is still an open challenge to all of jinn and mankind to produce some thing similar to Quran and this challenge will continue to be operative until the day of Judgment.

The Types of I'jaaz.

How is the Qur'aan inimitable ? In other words ,what aspect of the Qur'aan makes it so miraculous? And what are those aspects of the Qur'aan that cannot be limited?

There have been numerous responses by the scholars of uloom al- Qur'aan: the Arabic of the Qur'aan; the laws and sharee'ah that the Qur'aan came with; the predictions thet it gives;the diligence with which it was preserved, and so forth. In reality, the correct opinion is that all of theseaspects, and more from an integral part of the I'jaaz of the Qur'aan. In other words , the beauty of the Qur'aan is that it is not just miraculous in one facet, but rather from all facets and angles that one can look at it.

The scholar Muhammad ibn Juzay al-kalbee (d.741 A.H) divided the I'jaaz of the Qur'aan into ten categories:

- The eloquence of the Qur'aan above that of any human speech.

- The unique arrangement and organization of its verses and soorahs, and the manner in which the words are arranged.
- The incapability to produce anything similar to it by the disbelievers during the prophet's () time and those after them.
- The stories and accounts of the nations and prophets () of old , since the prophet () had no recourse to such information.
- The prediction which occurred in the Qur'aan , and which later came true.
- The names and attributes of Allaah, all glory be to him, and the attribution of all that befits him, and the negation of all that does not befit him, and the call of the creator to the created to worship him (in other words the perfect aqeedah). All of this is not possible for a human to bring forth. Unless he was inspired by Allaah.
- The laws and sharee'ah that the Qur'aan came with, and the morals and conduct that it called for all of this leads to the betterment of life in this world and in the here after. The perfection of a set of laws that can be applied to any society at any time and place is humanly impossible, and the sharee'ah is the only example of such a set of laws.
- The fact it has been protected and remained unchanged over such a long period of time, despite the fact that all other religious books have been distorted.
- The ease by which it is memorised, and this is known by experience and observance. This is in contrast to all the religious books, for none of them are memorised like the Qur'aan.
- The deep meanings that are present in it, and the fact that a reader never tires of reading the Qur'aan, no matter how many times he has heard it or read it. This is in contrast to any other book, since a person can not read it more than a few times without it getting monotonous and mundane.

Again the i'jaaz of the Qur'aan can not be limited to one list. There are other aspects of the i'jaaz of the Qur'aan that have not been mentioned in this list , including the Qur'aan's stating of scientific facts that were unknown at the time of the prophet (); the impact that it has on those who listen to it; the miracles nature of the ahraf , and what remains of them in the qiraat; the euphonious quality of the Qur'aan, and many more aspects.

Some scientific aspects of Ijaz found in the Quran:

سَنُرِيهِمْ آيَاتِنَا فِي الْأَفَاقِ وَفِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ حَتَّى يَتَبَيَّنَ لَهُمْ أَنَّهُ الْحَقُّ أَوَلَمْ يَكْفِ بِرَبِّكَ أَنَّهُ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ شَهِيدٌ (فصلت-53)

41:53 Soon will We show them Our signs in the (furthest) regions and in themselves until it becomes manifest to them that this (Quran) is the truth. Is it not enough that your Lord is witness over all things?

Existence of the universe as single unit prior to separation through “Big Bang” into component systems and its expansion following separation:

In 1922 and 1924 Russian mathematician Alexander Friedman published papers that used solutions to Einstein’s general theory of relativity to predict the expansion of the universe. American astronomer Edwin Hubble demonstrated that ours (Milky Way) was not the only galaxy; there were some hundred thousand million galaxies spaced far between. Friedman

Models predicted that all galaxies were moving away from each other. In other words, the universe has been expanding ever since it began. His models thus indicated that at some point of time in the past, the galaxies were together and compressed into a tiny mass of infinite density. This point of infinite density is known in physics as “singularity” to which the Cambridge astrophysicist Fred Hoyle gave the fashionable epithet „big-bang” . Time had a beginning at the big bang. Later, Roger Penrose, a British physicist and Stephen Hawking showed that the general theory of relativity implied that the universe had a beginning and possibly, it would have an end too .Allah says:

(30)–أَوَلَمْ يَرَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَنَّ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ أَفَلَا يُؤْمِنُونَ (الانبیاء)

21:30 Do not the unbelievers see that the skies and the earth were joined together (as one unit) before We clove them asunder? We made from water every organism. Will they not believe then?

47)–وَالسَّمَاءَ بَنَيْنَاهَا بِأَيْدٍ وَإِنَّا لَمُوسِعُونَ (الذاریات)

51:47 With hands did We construct the sky: For it is We who create the vastness of space (i.e., expansion of the universe).

Primordial 'smoke',

A team of astronomers headed by Michele Fumagalli at the University of California, Santa Cruz (UCSC) reported in 2011 the detection of two clouds of gas that formed in the first few minutes after the big bang that created the universe. The primordial gas clouds were found to contain only light elements (hydrogen and helium). A few hundred million years later, clumps of these gas clouds condensed to form the first stars, which created and dispersed heavier elements throughout the universe. The new observations appear to match the theoretical predictions about the chemical makeup of the early universe. The discovery of the pristine gas clouds offers the scientific proof of the Quranic revelation of the primordial smoke.

Allah informs us that the first component of the universe to be created was Earth. The rest of the universe was then „smoke“. The Quranic revelation of the primordial state of the universe as „smoke“ may be taken to mean the gas cloud produced by the big bang.

فصلت 9 ﴿قُلْ أَنْتُمْ لَكُمْ ذِكْرُكُمْ بِالَّذِي خَلَقَ الْأَرْضَ فِي يَوْمَيْنِ وَتَجْعَلُونَ لَهُ أَنْدَادًا ذَلِكَ رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ

41:9 Say: Do you deny the One (Allah) who created the earth in two Days and (also) invent equals to Him? He is the Lord of the worlds.

وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رَوَاسِيَ مِنْ فَوْقِهَا وَبَارَكَ فِيهَا وَقَدَّرَ فِيهَا أَقْوَاتَهَا فِي أَرْبَعَةِ أَيَّامٍ سَوَاءً لِلنَّاسِ لِيَوْمٍ (10) ثُمَّ اسْتَوَى إِلَى السَّمَاءِ وَهِيَ دُخَانٌ فَقَالَ لَهَا وَلِلْأَرْضِ ائْتِيَا طَوْعًا أَوْ كَرْهًا قَالَتَا أَتَيْنَا طَائِعِينَ (11)

41.10 He set on the (earth), mountains standing firm, high above it, and bestowed blessings on the earth, and measure therein all things to give them nourishment in due proportion, in four Days, in accordance with (the needs of) those who seek (Sustenance).

41:11 Then He turned to the sky and it was „smoke“. He said to it and to the earth: “You both come together willingly or as from compulsion. They said: “We do come (together) obediently.”

Fixation of mountains like pegs:

The firmly rooted formation of the mountains is now widely accepted. The mountains are not just protrusions on the Earth’s surface but have subterraneous extensions that anchor them firmly. Mountains also function as stabilizers. Peter Molnar, Professor of Geological Sciences, University of Colorado at Boulder, in a paper published in *Scientific American* wrote: “What holds mountains up? Some stand on plates of strong

rock; others are buoyed by crustal roots reaching deep into the mantle. The latter may collapse when their flanks are not pushed together.”

Zaghloul El-Naggar, professor of earth science and geology is well-known for his research work in this area. It is found in his website:

“The modern theory of plate tectonics holds that mountains act as anchorages for the earth’s crust. The crust is broken up into several tectonic plates through cracks that range from 65 to 150 kilometers in depth; there are about 12 large plates and several small ones. These plates, which contain the world’s continents and oceans, float on hot, semi-molten material, drifting and bumping against one another. Movement between the plates occurs along a relatively narrow zone where plate tectonic forces are most active i.e. in a weak zone of the earth’s crust. Thus the movement of those plates floating on molten magma coupled with the Earth’s movement around itself amount to a lot of force.

The Quran reveals to us that the mountains are fixed on the earth as pegs to prevent shaking or tilting.

أَلَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ مِهَادًا (6) وَالْجِبَالَ أَوْتَادًا (7) النباء

78:6-7 Have We not made the earth a vast expanse and the mountains as pegs?

خَلَقَ السَّمَاوَاتِ بِغَيْرِ عَمَدٍ تَرَوْنَهَا وَأَلْقَى فِي الْأَرْضِ رَوَاسِيَ أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ وَبَثَّ فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ دَابَّةٍ وَأَنْزَلْنَا مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَنْبَتْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ

كُلِّ رَوْحٍ كَرِيمٍ (10) لقمان

31:10 “He created the skies without any visible pillar and He fixed on the earth nails (mountains), lest it would tilt with you...”

21:31 “And We have made (mountains) firmly fixed on the earth to prevent its tilting with them....”

16:15 “And He has established on the earth (mountains) standing firm lest it (Earth) should tilt with you....”

The shrinking Earth

Vyacheslav Orlenok, professor of geology at the Kant Russian State University in Kaliningrad showed that the radius of the earth has now reduced by 585 km. The estimated original radius of the earth was 6956 km. Over the eons, this shrinking process has caused reduction of the earth’s surface by 128 million square kilometers. The shrinking is a major factor in tectonic processes. The reduction of size was explained as due to gravitational forces and the loss of mass caused by the sun’s radiation blowing away hydrogen atoms from the earth’s atmosphere.

The Quran reveals to us about the shrinking of the earth.

أَوَلَمْ يَرَوْا أَنَّا نَأْتِي الْأَرْضَ نَنْقُصُهَا مِنْ أَطْرَافِهَا وَاللَّهُ يَحْكُمُ لَا مُعَقَّبَ لِحُكْمِهِ وَهُوَ سَرِيعُ الْحِسَابِ (41)الرعد

13:41 Do they not see that We certainly shrink the earth from its boundaries? Allah decrees. There is none to delay His verdict. And He is swift in calling to account.

بَلْ مَتَّعْنَا هَؤُلَاءِ وَآبَاءَهُمْ حَتَّى طَالَ عَلَيْهِمُ الْعُمُرُ أَفَلَا يَرَوْنَ أَنَّا نَأْتِي الْأَرْضَ نَنْقُصُهَا مِنْ أَطْرَافِهَا أَفَهُمُ الْغَالِبُونَ (44)الانباء

21:44 We gave the good things of this life to these people and their fathers until they had a prolonged life. Then do they not see We are gradually shrinking the earth from its various sectors? Are they then the victors?

Human embryology

خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ ثُمَّ جَعَلَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَأُنْزِلَ لَكُمْ مِنَ الْأَنْعَامِ ثَمَانِيَةَ أَزْوَاجٍ يَخْلُقْكُمْ فِي بُطُونِ أُمَّهَاتِكُمْ خَلْقًا مِنْ بَعْدِ خَلْقٍ فِي ظُلُمَاتٍ ثَلَاثٍ ذَلِكُمْ اللَّهُ رَبُّكُمْ لَهُ الْمُلْكُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ فَأَنَّى تُصْرَفُونَ (6)الزمر

39:6 He created you (all) from a single soul (*nafs*); then He created from it its mate; and he sent down from the cattle eight pairs; He develops you in your mothers' wombs in stages one after another in three veils of darkness. That is Allah – your Lord; to Him belongs (all) dominion. There is no God but He; then how do you get misled (from the truth)?

“The three veils of darkness” may refer to: (1) the anterior abdominal wall; (2) the uterine wall; and (3) the amniochorionic membrane.

ثُمَّ جَعَلْنَاهُ نُطْقَةً فِي قَرَارٍ مَكِينٍ (13) ثُمَّ خَلَقْنَا النُّطْقَةَ عَلَقَةً فَخَلَقْنَا الْعَلَقَةَ مُضْغَةً فَخَلَقْنَا الْمُضْغَةَ عِظَامًا فَكَسَوْنَا الْعِظَامَ لَحْمًا ثُمَّ أَنْشَأْنَاهُ خَلْقًا آخَرَ فَتَبَارَكَ اللَّهُ أَحْسَنُ الْخَالِقِينَ (14)المؤمنون

23:13-14 Then We placed him as drop (zygote) in a safe place. Then We transformed the drop (zygote) into a clot of congealed blood; then We transformed that clot into a lump of flesh; then we transformed that flesh into bones and clothed the bones with flesh; then We developed it into another creation (i.e., from zygote to human being). So blessed be Allah, the best of creators!

The drop or *nutfah* is generally translated as sperm or spermatozoon. According to Moore, “a more meaningful interpretation would be the zygote which divides to form a blastocyst which is implanted in the uterus (“a place of rest”)

“The word “*alaqah*” refers to a leech or bloodsucker. This is an appropriate description of the human embryo from days 7-24 when it clings to the endometrium of the uterus, in the same way that a leech clings to the skin. Just as the leech derives blood from the host, the

human embryo derives blood from the decidua or pregnant endometrium. It is remarkable how much the embryo of 23-24 days resembles a leech

The Arabic word “mudghah” means “chewed substance or chewed lump.” Toward the end of the fourth week, the human embryo looks somewhat like a chewed lump of flesh

First the bones form as cartilage models and then the muscles (flesh) develop around them from the somatic mesoderm.”

The bones and muscles result in the formation of another creature. This may refer to the human-like embryo that forms by the end of the eighth week. At this stage it has distinctive human characteristics and possesses the primordia of all the internal and external organs and parts

إِنَّا خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ نُطْفَةٍ أَمْشَاجٍ نَبْتَلِيهِ فَجَعَلْنَاهُ سَمِيعًا بَصِيرًا

76:2 Verily We created man from a mixed drop (zygote) in order to test him. So We gave him faculties of hearing and sight.

The zygote forms by the union of a mixture of the sperm and the ovum (“The mixed drop”).

Chapter-7 General Information about Sunnah and Hadith

- **Lexical definition of Sunnah/Hadith:** Lexically Sunnah means way,path, habitual practice,custom etc.. Lexically Hadith means Something new, story, to tell

- **Terminological definition of Sunnah/Hadith:**

“What has been passed down from the prophet (peace be upon him) of his statement, action, tacit approvals, manners, physical characteristics or biography,

An example of one of his statement in the hadith narrated by Umar ibn al –Khataab that the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) said, **إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ وَإِنَّمَا لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مَا نَوَى فَمَنْ هَجَرْتُهُ إِلَى دُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوْ إِلَى امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا فَهَجَرْتُهُ إِلَى مَا هَاجَرَ إِلَيْهِ كَأَنَّهُ هَجَرْتُهُ إِلَى**

“Surely, all actions are but driven by intentions and, verily, every man shall have but that which he intended. thus, he whose migration was for Allah and his Messenger, [then] his migration was for Allah and his Messenger ; and he Whose migration was to achieve some worldly benefit or to take a woman in marriage, his migration for that which he migrated.

An example of one his action is the following report recorded on the authority of Aishah:

أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ كَانَ إِذَا صَلَّى رَكَعَتَيِ الْفَجْرِ فِي بَيْتِهِ اضْطَجَعَ عَلَى يَمِينِهِ

He used to sleep on his right flank after performing two rakah of Sunnah prayer of Fajr

An example of the Prophet’s tacit approval is found in the hadith from *Sahih Muslim* in which Anas was asked if the Prophet (peace be upon him) ever performed the two *rakats* of prayer before the *Maghrib* (Sunset) Prayer. He replied, “He used to see us performing them and he would neither order us to do them or forbid us from performing An example of a report describing the Prophet’s manner or behavior is:

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ الْخُدْرِيِّ قَالَ

كَانَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ أَشَدَّ حَيَاءً مِنْ الْعَذْرَاءِ فِي خُدْرِهَا فَإِذَا رَأَى شَيْئًا يَكْرَهُهُ عَرَفْتَاهُ فِي وَجْهِهِ

“The Prophet (peace be upon him) was more bashful than the virgin girls kept in their private compartments. If he saw anything he did not like, we would recognize it by [the expression on] his face.’ (recorded by al-Bukhari and Muslim.)

Reports describing the Prophet's physical characteristics are numerous. They are reports about his height and physical appearance. For example, ibn Umar narrated that the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) had approximately twenty gray hairs. Another example is the report from Jaabir ibn Saumurah that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had a full beard. (Recorded by Muslim.)

Reports concerning his biography include the report that he married Khadeejah when he was twenty-five years old while they were living in Makkah and before he had received his first revelation. Also included in this category would be the reports that he lived in Makkah for thirteen years after receiving revelation and then migrated to Madinah.

Importance of Sunnah:

1. Revelation: The Prophet's sayings and actions were primarily based on revelation from Allaah and, as such, must be considered a fundamental source of guidance second only to the Qur'aan. Allaah in the Qur'aan said concerning the Prophet (Muhammad) **does not speak from his desires; indeed, what he says is revelation.**" (*Soorah an-Najm*, 53: 3-4)

Therefore, the *hadeeth* represents a personal source of divine guidance which Allaah granted His Prophet (r) which was similar in its nature to the Qur'aan itself. The Prophet (r) reiterated this point in one of his recorded statements,

"Indeed, I was given the Qur'aan and something similar to it along with it."

2. Tafseer:

The preservation of the Qur'aan was not restricted to protecting its wording from change. Were that the case, its meanings could be manipulated according to human desires, while maintaining its wording. However, Allaah also protected its essential meanings from change by entrusting the explanation of the meanings of Qur'aan to the Prophet (r) himself. Allaah states the following in the Qur'aan regarding its interpretation:

"And I revealed to you the Reminder (Qur'aan) in order that you explain to the people what was revealed to them." (*Soorah an-Nahl*, 16: 44)

Therefore, if one is to understand the meanings of Qur'aan, he or she must consider what the Prophet (r) said or did regarding it. E.g. in the Qur'aan, Allaah instructs the believers to offer *salaah* (formal prayers) and pay *zakaah* (obligatory charity) in *Soorah al-Baqarah*, (2), verse 43. However, in order to obey these instructions correctly, one must study the methodology of the Prophet (r) in this regard. Among his many clarifications concerning *Salaah* and *zakaah*, he instructed his followers saying *"Pray as you saw me pray,"* and he specified that 2.5% of surplus wealth, unused for a year, should be given as *zakaah*.

3. Laws : One of the primary duties of the Prophet (r) was to judge between people in their disputes. Since his judgments were all based on revelation, as stated earlier, they must be considered a primary source of principles by which judgments are carried out in an Islaamic State. Allaah also addressed this responsibility in the Qur'aan saying:

"O believers obey Allaah, obey the Messenger and those in authority"

among you. If you dispute about anything, refer it to Allaah and the Messenger.” (*Soorah an-Nisaa*, 4: 59)

Thus, *hadeeths* are essential for the smooth running of the law courts in an Islaamic State.

4. Moral Ideal

Since the Prophet (r) was guided by revelation in his personal life, his character and social interactions became prime examples of moral conduct for Muslims until the Last Day. Attention was drawn to this fact in the following Qur’aanic verse:

“Surely there is for all of you a good example (of conduct) in the way of Allaah’s Messenger.” (*Soorah al-Ahzaab*, 33: 21)

Consequently, the daily life of the Prophet (r) as recorded in *hadeeth* represents an ideal code of good conduct. In fact, when the Prophet’s wife, ‘Aa’ishah, was asked about his conduct, she replied, “His character was the Qur’aan.”¹⁰

5. Preservation of Islaam

The science of narration, collection and criticism of *hadeeth* was unknown to the world prior to the era of the Prophet (r). In fact, it was due in part to the absence of such a reliable science that the messages of the former prophets became lost or distorted in the generations that followed them. Therefore, it may be said that it is largely due to the science of *hadeeth* that the final message of Islaam has been preserved in its original purity for all times. This is alluded to in the Qur’aanic verse:

“Indeed, I have revealed the Reminder, I will, indeed, protect it.”
(*Soorah al-Hijr*, 15: 9)

Collection & Compilation of Hadith / *Sunnah*:

The Collection & Compilation of *Sunnah* came about in three ways :

1. The Ummah acting upon the *Sunnah*
2. Memorisation and writing.
3. Narrating and teaching *Sunnah* in study circles.

Using these methods the gathering, compilation, classification, formation and writing of over time *Sunnah* can be classified into four periods. They are:

THE FIRST PERIOD

This era extended from the lifetime of the Messenger of Allaah (sal-Allaahu alayhe wa sallam) up until the first century Hijrah. In this period *ahaadeeth* were gathered by memorisation, teaching and compilations. The details of this are:

Famous Memorizers of Hadeeth

The Sahaabah (Companions)

1. Abu Hurairah (Abdur-Rahmaan) (radi-Allaahu ‘anhu) d.59H at the age of 78; he narrated 5374 *ahaadeeth*. The number of his students reaches 800
2. Abdullaah Ibn Abbaas (radi-Allaahu ‘anhu) d.68H at the age of 71; he

narrated 2660 ahaadeeth

3. Aa'ishah Siddeeqa (radi-Allaahu 'anhaa) d.58H at the age of 67; she narrated 2210 ahaadeeth

These Companions were amongst those who had memorised more than 1000 ahaadeeth.

Abdullaah Ibn Amr Ibn al-Aas (radi-Allaahu 'anhu) d.63H

9. Alee Ibn Abee Taalib (radi-Allaahu 'anhu) d.40H and

10. Umar Ibn al-Khattaab (radi-Allaahu 'anhu) d.33H

Are amongst those Companions who narrated between 500 and 1000 ahaadeeth

11. Abu Bakr as-Siddeeq (radi-Allaahu 'anhu) d.13H

12. Uthmaan Ibn Affaan Dhun-Noorain (radi-Allaahu 'anhu) d.36H

13. Umm Salamah (radi-Allaahu 'anhaa) d.59H

Are amongst those Companions who narrated more than 100 but less than 500 ahaadeeth.

The Taabi'een (Successors)

And we cannot forget the major Taabi'een (Successors) who, after endless striving, gathered the treasures of the Sunnah so the Ummah of Muhammad (sal-Allaahu 'alayhe wa sallam) could become enriched with it forever; from amongst them are:

1) *Sa'eed Ibn al-Mussayab*

2) *Urwah Ibn Zubair*

3) *Saalim Ibn Abdullaah Ibn Umar*

4) *Naaf'i*

The Written Works of the First Period

1. Saaheefa Saadiqaa

This has been attributed to Abdullaah Ibn Amr al-Aas (d.63H at the age of 77) This treatise is composed of about 1000 ahaadeeth. It remained secure and preserved within his family for a long time.

2. Saaheefa Saheehaa

This is attributed to Humaam Ibn Munabbah (rahimahullaah) (d.101H). This *Saaheefa* is a part of the ahaadeeth narrated from Abu Hurairah

3. Saaheefa Basheer Ibn Naheek

He was the student of Abu Hurairah (radi-Allaahu 'anhu). He also gathered and wrote a treatise of ahaadeeth which he read to Abu Hurairah (radi-Allaahu 'anhu), before

they departed, and he verified it.

4. Musnad Abu Hurairah (radi-Allaahu ‘anhu)

It was written during the time of the Companions.

5. Saaheefa Alee (radi-Allaahu ‘anhu).

During this time the Companions (radi-Allaahu ‘anhum) and the major Successors concentrated on using their memories to write. During the second period the gathering of ahaadeeth started.

THE SECOND PERIOD

The second period started from about half of the second century Hijrah. During this time a major group of the Successors compiled earlier works into the form of books.

Compilers of Hadeeth

1. Muhammad Ibn Shihaab az-Zuhree (d.124H) (rahimahullaah)

He is considered from amongst the greatest Scholars of Hadeeth of his time.

During the year 101H he was instructed by Umar Ibn Abdul Azeez (rahimahullaah) to gather and compile hadeeth. Apart from this Umar Ibn Abdul Azeez (rahimahullaah) gave guidance to the Governor of Madeenah, Abu Bakr Muhammad Ibn Amr Ibn Hazm, to write all the ahaadeeth which Umrah bint Abdur Rahmaan and Qaasim Ibn Muhammad had.

Umrah was from the main students of Aa’ishah (radi-Allaahu ‘anhaa) and Qaasim Ibn Muhammad her brother. Aa’ishah (radi-Allaahu ‘anhaa) looked after and educated him.

When Umar Ibn Abdul Azeez (rahimahullaah) commanded all the responsible people within the Islamic state to gather ahaadeeth, it resulted in books. When they reached the capital Damascus, copies were sent to every corner (i.e. every corner of the Muslim lands). After Imaam az-Zuhree (rahimahullaah) started collecting ahaadeeth, other people of knowledge of his time joined him. The major ones from amongst them include:

2. Abdul Maalik Ibn Juraij (rahimahullaah) (d.150H) in Makkah

3. Imaam al-Awzaa’ee (rahimahullaah) (d.157H) in Shaam (Syria)

4. Mu’ammarr Ibn Raashid (rahimahullaah) (d.153H) in Yemen

5. Imaam Sufyaan ath-Thawree (rahimahullaah) (d.161H) in Koofah

6. Imaam Hamaad Ibn Salamah (rahimahullaah) (d.167H) in Basra

7. Abdullaah Ibn al-Mubaarak (rahimahullaah) (d.181H) in Khurasaan and

8. Maalik Ibn Anas (rahimahullaah) (b.93H / d.179H)

The Written Works of the Second Period

Other Works of the Second Period

1. Muwatta Imaam Maalik

During this time a number of books of hadeeth were compiled; Muwatta had a

status in this period. It was written between 130H and 141H. It has approximately 1720 ahaadeeth from which:

600 are marfoo (raised to the Prophet sal-Allaahu ‘alayhe wa sallam)

222 are mursal (omission of the Companion)

617 are mawqoof (to a Successor only)

275 are the sayings of Successors.²²

Other Books Compiled during this Time

2. Jaami Sufyaan ath-Thawree (d.161H)

3. Jaami Abdullaah Ibn al-Mubaarak (d.181H)

4. Jaami Imaam al-Awzaa’ee (d.157H)

5. Jaami Ibn Juraij (d.150H)

6. Kitaab al-Akhraj of Qaadhi Abu Yoosuf (d.182H)

7. Kitaab al-Athaar of Imaam Muhammad (d.189H)

During this time the ahaadeeth of the Messenger of Allaah (sal-Allaahu ‘alayhe wa sallam), athaar of the Companions and verdicts of the Successors were gathered, accompanied with explanations that a particular statement was of a Companion or a Successor or a hadeeth [of the Messenger of Allaah (sal- Allaahu ‘alayhe wa sallam)]

THE THIRD PERIOD

This period extended from about half of the second century Hijrah to the end of the fourth century Hijrah.

Specificity of this Period

1. Prophetic ahaadeeth, athaar of the Companions and statements of the Successors were categorised and a distinction made between them.

2. Narrations that were accepted were gathered separately and the books of the second century were checked and authenticated.

3. During this period not only were the narrations gathered but to preserve ahaadeeth, the scholars formulated sciences, (more than 100²³) on which thousands of books have been written.

Uloom al-Hadeeth (The Sciences of Hadeeth)

1. Asma ar-Rijal

In this science the condition, births, deaths, teachers and students of narrators were gathered in detail and from these details judgments on the position of the narrators, as to whether they were truthful, trustworthy or unreliable, were made. This science is very interesting; details of over 500,000 narrators have been collated.

2. Ilm Masatalah al-Hadeeth (Usool of Hadeeth)

In the light of this knowledge the standard and rules of ahaadeeth, their authenticity and weakness were established.

3. Ilm Ghareeb al-Hadeeth

In this knowledge the meaning of difficult words (in Arabic) have been investigated and researched.²⁷

4. Ilm Takhreej al-Hadeeth

From this knowledge we find where a particular hadeeth pertaining to a particular science can be found from the well known books of tafseer (Exegesis of the Qur’aan),

belief and jurisprudence.

5. *Ilm al-Hadeeth al-Mawdoo'ah*

In this science the people of knowledge have written books in which they separated the mawdoo (fabricated, forged) narration's from the authentic ones

Compilers of Hadeeth in the Third Period

1. *Imaam Ahmad Ibn Hanbal (rahimahullaah) (b.164H d.241H)*

His most important work is *Musnad Ahmad*, it is the composition of 30,000 ahaadeeth in 24 volumes

2. *Imaam Muhammad Ibn Ismaa'eel Bukhaaree (rahimahullaah) (b.194H d.246H)*

Saheeh al-Bukhaaree is the most important work of Imaam Bukhaaree.

3. *Imaam Muslim Ibn Hajaaj al-Qushaaree (rahimahullaah) (b.202H d.261H)*

His important book is famous by the name of Muslim shareef.

4. *Abu Daawood Isha'at Ibn Sulaimaan as-Sijastanee (rahimahullaah) (b.204H d.275H)*

His important book is famous by the name of *Sunan Abu Daawood*.

5. *Imaam Abu Eesaa at-Tirmidhee (rahimahullaah) (b.209H d.279H)*

His book *Jaami Tirmidhee* mentions issues of fiqh with detailed explanations.

6. *Imaam Ahmad Ibn Shu'ayb an-Nasaa'ee (rahimahullaah) (d.303H)*

His book is named *Sunan al-Mujtabah/ An nasa'ee*

7. *Imaam Muhammad Ibn Yazeed Ibn Maajah al-Qazdi'aanee (rahimahullaah) (d.273H)*

His book is famous by the name *Sunan Ibn Maajah*.

THE FOURTH PERIOD

This period extends from the start of the fifth century up until today. The works done in this time are:

1. Explanations, footnotes and translations of important books of hadeeth into other languages.
2. More books on the sciences that have been mentioned and explanations and summaries of them.
3. The people of knowledge, due to their keenness and necessity for them, compiled books of hadeeth taken from those books written or compiled in the 3rd Century.

From them are:

Mishkaat al-Masabeeh

Riyadh us-Saaliheen

Chapter-8

Explanation of some important terms of Sunnah, Classification of *Hadith* and fabrication in Hadith:

Explanation of some important terms of Sunnah:

Sanad/Isnad :The chain of narrator which reaches back to the text.

Matan: That which the chain of narrators ends at.

Example: [Imam Bukhary says: narrates us Humaidye, he says: narrates us Sufiyan, he says: narrates us Yahya bin sayeed al ansary, he says: informs us Muhammad bin Ibrahim at-taymee ,he hears Alqama bin wqqas al-laythy to say that I heard Umar bin khattab as stating that the prophet (Saw) says:] sanad

[“Surely, all actions are but driven by intentions and, verily, every man shall have but that which he intended. thus, he whose migration was for Allah and his Messenger, [then] his migration was for Allah and his Messenger ; and he Whose migration was to achieve some worldly benefit or to take a woman in marriage, his migration for that which he migrated.] matan

Rawee: The narrator of a hadith is called rawee. He is basically a companion. He also may be a successor or a follower of successor or any one after him.

Riwayah: The act of narrator is riwayah. It also refers to the hadith.

Al-jame': Every book of hadith which covers the hadiths of each topic related to Islam. Like biography, good manners ,exegesis, belief, softening the heart, signs of the resurrection day, rulings, virtues and merits of the companions etc..

Al-Musnad:The book of hadith which includes the hadiths in the order of companions in such way to mention them in alphabetic order or advancement in Islam or nobility of lineage.

Al-Sahih: It is a compilation of hadith which includes only sahih hadiths .Such as: Al bukhari, Al muslim etc.

Al-Sunan: The book hadith in which the hadiths of ruling are written down in accordance with the order of Islamic jurisprudence.

Sahihain: The Al bukhari and Al muslim together are called Sahihain.

Muttafaqun alayhi: The hadith which is mentioned in Al bukhari and Al muslim simultaneously.

The Classification of Hadeeth

Depending on the number of the reporters of the hadith, it can be classified into the two categories

1. Mutawatir
2. Ahad

Mutawatir:

A mutawatir hadith is one which is reported by such a large number of people that they cannot be expected to agree upon a lie, all of them together

Example: "Whoever lies about me intentionally, let him reserve his seat in the Fire.

Ahad: A hadith ahad or khabar wahid is one which is narrated by people whose number does not reach that of the mutawatir case.

Ahad is further classified into

- Mashhur,
- 'Aziz
- Gharib

Gharib: A hadith is termed gharib when a single reporter is found relating it, usually at the beginning of the isnad (i.e., only one Companion relates it from the Prophet)

Example:

"Travel is a part of torment" is gharib; the isnad of this hadith contains only one reporter in each stage:

Malik --- Yahya b. Abi Salih --- Abu Huraira --- The Prophet.

'Aziz: If at any stage in the isnads, only two reporters are found to narrate the hadith, it is termed 'aziz.

Example: Anas reported that the Messenger of Allah said,
"None of you believes until I become more beloved to him than his own son, his father and all mankind."
Two reporters, Qatada and 'Abdul 'Aziz b. Shu'aib, report this hadith from Anas, and two more
reporters narrate from each of them: Shu'ba and Sa'id report from Qatada, and Isma'il b. Ulayya and 'Abd al-Warith from 'Abd al-'Aziz. Then a group of people report from each of them.

Mashhur: A hadith which is reported by more than two reporters is known as mashhur. According to some scholars, every narrative which comes to be known widely, whether or not it has an authentic origin, is called mashhur.

A mashhur hadith might be reported by only one or two reporters in the beginning but become widely-known later, unlike gharib or 'aziz, which are reported by one or two reporters in the beginning and continue to have the same number even in the times of the Successors and those after them. For example, if only one or two reporters are found narrating hadith from a reliable authority in Hadith such as al-Zuhri and Qatada, the hadith will remain either gharib or 'aziz. On the other hand, if a group of people narrate from them it will be then known as mashhur.

Example: "Actions are (judged) according to their intentions."

The Classification of Hadeeth - According to the reference to a particular authority: With regards to a particular authority Hadeeth can be classified into three types:

- Marfoo'
- Mauqoof
- Maqtoo'

Marfoo': Linguistically means raised up. In the terminology, A hadith referred back /attributed to the Prophet, e.g. a reporter (whether a Companion, Successor or other) says, "The Messenger of Allah said ..."

Example: The hadith narrated by Umar ibn al -Khataab that the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) said: Actions are (judged) according to their intentions."

Mauqoof: Lexically means suspended, stopped. In the terminology, A hadith referred back to a Companion, e.g. 'Ali ® said "...", without being attributed to the Prophet

Example: 'Ali ® said, "You should preach to the people according to their mental caliber so that they may not convey wrong things about Allah and His Messenger

Maqtoo': Literally means, cut off. In the terminology, A hadith referred back to a Successor, e.g. "Al-Hasan al-Basri said ..."

Example: Al-Uasan said, "You can offer prayers behind a heretic *ma'm* and the sin of heresy will be against him."

The Classification of Hadeeth - According to the reliability and memory of the reporters: With respect to the reliability and memory of the reporters hadiths are divided into four categories:

- Saheeh (sound)
- Hasan (agreeable)
- Da'eef (weak)

- Maudoo' (fabricated)

Saheeh (sound) :A sahih hadith is the one which has a continuous isnad, made up of reporters of trustworthy and precise (preservers from similar authorities), and which is found to be clear from shudhudh and any defects.

Example: The hadith narrated by Umar ibn al -Khataab that the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) said: Actions are (judged) according to their intentions."

Hasan (agreeable): A hasan hadith is the one which has a continuous isnad, made up of reporters of trustworthy but not precise , and which is found to be clear from shudhudh and any defects.

Example: Imam Tirmidhi says: Narrate us Qutyba and Jafor from Abu Imran from Abu Bakr who says :I heard my father as stating before an enemy that the doors of jannah are under the shadow of swords.

In this hadith, the reporter Jafor is weak in precision

Da'eef (weak):

A hadith which fails to reach the status of hasan due to missing any condition for it .

Example: Imam Tirmidhi finds out on the authority of Hakim al artham from abu tamimah alhajamee from abu hurirah (R) who says:the Prophet says: whoever has sexual intercourse with a menstruating women or with a women through anus or with a soothsayer, disbelieves that which are revealed upon Mohammad (saw).

Hakim al artham is weak narrator in isnad of this hadith.

Maudoo' (fabricated): Al-Dhahabi defines it as a hadith, the text of which goes against the established norms or its reporters include a liar

Example: Conversation in Masjid/Masque eats up good deeds the way animals consume grass.

The Classification of Hadeeth - According to the link found among the reporters

The following categories fall under this heading:

- Musnad
- **Mursal**
- **Munqati'**
- **Mu'dal**
- Mu'allaq

Musnad: "A hadith which a traditionist reports from his shaikh from whom he is known to have heard (ahadith) at a time of life suitable for learning, and similarly in turn for each shaikh, until the isnad reaches a well-known Companion who turn reports from the Prophet."

Example: Imam Bukhary says: narrates us Humaidye, he says: narrates us Sufiyan, he says: narrates us Yahya bin sayeed al ansary, he says: informs us Muhammad bin Ibrahim at-taymee ,he hears Alqama bin wqqas al-laythy to say that I heard Umar bin khattab as stating that the prophet (Saw) says:

“Surely, all actions are but driven by intentions and, verily, every man shall have but that which he intended. thus, he whose migration was for Allah and his Messenger, [then] his migration was for Allah and his Messenger ; and he Whose migration was to achieve some worldly benefit or to take a woman in marriage, his migration for that which he migrated.

Mursal: If the link between the Successor and the Prophet is missing, the hadith is mursal. In other words, when a Successor says, "The Prophet said ..."

Munqati': If a link anywhere before the Successor (i.e. closer to the traditionist recording the hadith) is missing, the hadith is munqati'. This applies even if there is an apparent link, e.g. a reporter says, "A shaikh or a man reported to me ..." without naming this authority, or when an isnad is apparently muttasil (uninterrupted) but in reality a reporter is found not to have heard from his shaikh.

Mu'dal : If the number of missing reporters in the isnad exceeds one, the isnad is mu'dal

Mu'allaq: If the reporter omits the whole isnad and quotes the Prophet directly (i.e. the link is missing at the beginning, unlike the case with a mursal isnad), the hadith is called

mu'allaq (hanging); sometimes it is known as balaghat. For example, Malik says, "It reached me that the Messenger of Allah said ..."